

Five Steps to Financial Wellbeing

Maslow theorizes that the needs at the bottom of the pyramid must be satisfied before we can successfully fulfil those further up, which makes sense; but when I consider this pyramid, all I can think about is how closely linked money is to each and every one of the different levels. Even the most basic of our needs – food, water and rest – are impossible to meet without enough money to do so, and though the role of money changes as we move further down the hierarchy (or up the pyramid), its presence is constant. Money can dictate how safe and secure we feel, it can play a huge role in our intimate relationships, and it often acts as a measure of prestige and potential, both to ourselves and to others around us.

Seerut K. Chawla is a London-based integrative psychotherapist, whose insightful, human and utterly no-nonsense approach to wellbeing is absorbed by her 140k Instagram followers, including me (you can find her [@seerutkchawla](#), if you'd like to experience her wisdom first hand). Her inclusive and realistic posts often present a challenging new viewpoint, and her Instagram feed is one of few mental health accounts that actually addresses the role that financial security plays in our ability to be mentally well. In one such post, which draws a line between the ideal resources for mental health and the fundamental ones, she writes, 'You can't go on a "healing journey" if you can't think straight because you're scared you won't be able to pay your rent or buy groceries.' She goes on to explain that *not* being able to focus your resources on 'healing' doesn't mean that something is wrong,